

Oakter Basic Smart Home Kit

When it comes to setting up an automated home, it doesn't get more plug-n-play than this. The basic kit from Oakter comprises of a hub, a 6 amp smart plug and a 16 amp smart plug. You also need to install the Oakter app from the Play Store or the App Store to start using it. Before anything, you need to connect the hub to a power source and then fire up the app.

Your exclusive control over this setup is ensured by a login ID and password located within the package, which is required to sign-up on the app. Post that, you need to provide access to your home Wi-Fi from within the app. Once that is done, you can connect and operate your smart plugs just like enabling and disabling any particular toggle on your smartphone. You can also set up schedules for the switches to power on and off. For example, you're on your way home and you want a hot shower the moment you get back – just switch on the geyser at the right time from the app.

The setup is pretty basic in terms of what's available on the market right now, but it is reasonably priced too at ₹5,700/-. The only con in the setup are the switches themselves which are quite big. You may have to take into account the neighbouring switches and their accessibility if you're using one of these. But if you don't mind the size and the additional bulk on your switchboards, Oakter's Basic Smart Home kit is a pretty good way to boost your home's smartness quotient.



SPECIFICATIONS

Hub - WiFi: 802.11 b/g/n | **Input:** 5V 2A DC; **Firmware upgrade:** OTA

6 amp smart plug - Input: 200-250V AC | **Peak Load:** 10A
16 amp smart plug - Input: 200-250V AC | **Peak Load:** 20A

Price: ₹5,700/- (www.oakter.com)

Fastrack Reflex



Wearables are the eternal new-things in the tech market and every company even remotely related to this area is seemingly interested to dive in. So it isn't a surprise that Fastrack, a youth oriented Titan subsidiary, launched an activity tracker recently. Priced at Rs. 1995/- it sports pretty much the standard feature set you find in such devices, namely, step counter, sleep tracker, vibrating alarms, call and SMS

notifications, and so on. At that price point, a similar tracker from Xiaomi, the Mi Band 2, also offer a heart rate sensor – but calling that a deal breaker would be too harsh, especially since we rarely use that feature anyways.

The design is the strongest thing the Reflex has going for it, with a textured dual-color band upping the style quotient. The size of the band itself is a differentiating factor. The width is closer to that of the Microsoft Band, as compared to the generic design in fitness bands that is seen in most competitors. The metallic latch design adds an element of style to an already well designed band. To be fair, the rigidity does become an issue when you are trying to release the capsule from the strap to charge it, but in a few tries, you will be able to master the technique without risking damage.

The step and sleep detection are pretty standard and reasonably accurate. The app could use some work. The manual sync method is to refresh the data screen by pulling it down, which will, in turn, update the numbers from the band. The auto sync, however, was quite unpredictable.

Overall, if you are looking for an activity tracker that catches eyeballs while offering you the basic features reliably, made by a brand familiar from your teenage years, go for the Reflex.

Price: ₹1995/- (www.fastrack.in)